

FOR PRINCIPALS & SUPERINTENDENTS · 3-MINUTE READ

AI for Communication: Parent Messages and Tone

A 45–60 minute, self-facilitated session: every teacher takes their next real family message from blank page to scheduled send, starts a weekly positive-note habit, and learns tone repair for the hardest messages. Run by your own coach; no consultant required.

THE STANCE, AND YOUR PARENT ANSWER

AI drafts; teachers review, personalize, and send. Families hear the teacher, not the tool.
Sensitive news is always delivered personally, by voice, and official documents travel district translation channels, not AI.

Why this matters now

Family communication is the highest-leverage, least-resourced work in the building: in a summer program for students retaking a course they had failed, one individualized sentence home per week cut the failure rate by 41% (Kraft & Rogers, 2015). Yet it lives in the unpaid margins of a ~54-hour week (Merrimack/EdWeek, 2022). AI can return those hours, if the teacher's voice and review stay in charge.

What your staff will be able to do afterward

- Draft family messages in minutes with a four-part prompt, then pass every draft through voice and readability checks
- Run a weekly positive-note batch: AI-drafted starters, teacher-personalized sends
- Repair tone safely: "warmer, shorter, plainer," the read-aloud test, the 24-hour rule
- Write plain-language messages every family can read, human-reviewed before sending, with official documents routed to district translation channels, never DIY AI translation
- State the human-only list cold: safety, discipline, grief, and IEP news travel by voice
- Keep the privacy rule: situations, never student identities, go into public tools

Research base in brief

One-sentence teacher-family messages: Kraft & Rogers (2015) · District obligation to translate official communication: ED/DOJ Dear Colleague Letter (2015) · Teacher workweek: Merrimack College & EdWeek Research Center (2022) · Time savings and use patterns: Gallup & Walton Family Foundation (2025) · Humans in the loop: U.S. Department of Education OET (2023). Full APA citations ship in the kit's References file.

Where it fits

Kit 6 of 8 in **Track A: AI Foundations**. Ships with a 30-day plan (three 10-minute PLC follow-ups: batch check, message-makeover swap, template harvest) and an exit ticket that doubles as PD documentation. Kit 7 (AI for Workload) is next.

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi, certified educators. © AI-Ready School. Informational, not legal advice; consult district counsel. Check with your district or state whether this PD qualifies for local credit.